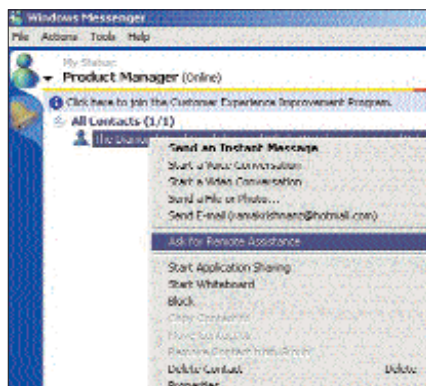




Inviting the expert to help you, using Windows Messenger, is just a right-click away

STEP 3 Running a Remote Assistance session

A dialog box informs you if the expert has accepted the invitation and is ready to connect to your computer. If you do not get a response after awhile, send an invitation again since your Internet connection might be weak. Click 'Yes' to let the expert view your desktop and chat with you. The expert will have to click on 'Take Control' in case you wish to let him or her have access to your desktop to solve the problem. Accordingly, Remote



This is the expert's view of your desktop



You can chat with the expert through this chat window

Assistance will prompt you on your machine. Choose 'Yes' to let the expert take control. Now, both you and the expert have control on your PC. You can disable access

to the expert by pressing [Esc]. The expert can also hand back control to you by clicking on 'Release Control'.

Send and receive files while using Remote Assistance by clicking on 'Send a File'. This can be done by both parties. The receiver is notified of the file transfer. You can also start a conversation by clicking on 'Start Talking'.

Other assistance

Windows XP Professional has an in-built tool, called Remote Desktop that lets you operate on your remote desktop PC. Note that Remote Desktop services are available only for the Windows XP Professional version.

All you need is the host, i.e., the Windows XP Professional machine and the local PC—the client running on any version of Windows. The PCs could be on the same LAN, VPN, or connected over the Internet.

STEP 4 Setting up the host computer

The host computer could be the one at your workplace or home. You would need to set it up before you can access it remotely. Log on as Administrator, since you will need to have Administrator rights to access the Remote options. Go to **Start > Settings > Control Panel**, and click on the System icon.

Flip across to the Remote tab and check 'Allow users to connect remotely to this computer'. Click on the 'Select Remote Users' tab. Here, click on Add to add users who intend to connect remotely. Either enter the usernames, or locate the usernames by clicking on Advanced. Ensure that the Location (computer name) is correctly set, and click on Find. Click OK, to get back to the Select Users menu. Again, click OK, and the user is added to the list. By default, the Administrator has access to the service. You can remove a user from the list by highlighting the username and clicking on Remove. Finally, click OK, and return to the Remote menu. Here click OK, and your system is set to receive the remote connections. You can now lock your Windows XP machine.



Ensure that Terminal Services, Remote Procedural Call (RPC), Remote Access Auto Connection Manager, Remote Access Connection Manager and Telephony are running on your PC before using any of the remote services. Go to **Start > Run** and type 'services.msc' to start the Services tool. Right-click on the service and click on Start to start it.

Also, click on Properties and ensure that all the associated services listed as Dependencies are activated.

Fast Moves

Apart from its flexibility, and the fact that it comes with Windows XP Professional, Remote Desktop has other great features that make it even more productive. If you happen to be working on your remote desktop from, say, your home PC, and should a family member want to use it for a while, you can use Windows XP's fast user switching feature to quickly log out from your user account and switch across individual accounts, without closing the applications. Resume work on your remote session once you log back into your account.

Enable Fast User Switching by going to **Start > Settings > Control Panel** and clicking on User Accounts. Here, click on 'Change the way users log on or off', check 'Use the Welcome screen' and enable 'Use Fast User Switching'. Finally, click on 'Apply Options' and exit. Remember to choose Switch Users while logging out. You will be logged off, but your applications will continue in the background.

Note that you also need to have the necessary associated services turned on to connect remotely.

Also remember to leave your computer turned on, and connected to the network—the Remote Desktop service will not be able to physically switch on your computer!

STEP 5 Setting up the client

You need to have the Remote Desktop Client software to connect to the host computer. By default, it's

installed in all Windows XP Professional and Home edition computers. You will have to install the Remote Desktop Client software separately for all other Windows editions.

STEP 6 Starting the session

Starting a remote desktop session is pretty simple. Go to **Start > Programs > Accessories > Communications** and click on 'Remote Desktop Connection'.